ACCENTURE 2026–2027 HIRING · TECHNICAL ASSESSMENT · SECTION A

MS Office & Common Applications Complete Guide

> ≈ 7 of 45 questions · formula outputs · features · shortcuts_

Everything you need for the MS Office section, from zero: Excel in depth (references, 60+ functions with outputs, lookups, errors, data tools, pivots), Word, PowerPoint, Outlook, Windows and file formats, plus mega shortcut tables and 60 practice MCQs with explained answers.

📗 Excel | 📘 Word | 📙 PowerPoint | ✉️ Outlook · Windows · File types

≈ 7	60+	150+	60
Questions in the test	Excel functions explained	Shortcuts in tables	MCQs, answers code-verified

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KNOW WHAT'S COMING

00 What's Tested & How to Prepare

This section has **about 7 questions** out of 45. They are short and recall-based, which makes them some of the **easiest marks** in the Technical Assessment if you prepare properly. Expect four kinds of question:

Question type	Example	How to prepare
1 · Formula output (most common)	"A sheet is shown. What does `=SUMIF(B2:B7,"HR",C2:C7)` return?"	Sections X3–X7, and practise on a real sheet
2 · Feature / purpose	"Which feature restricts input to a drop-down list?" or "Which break allows a landscape page?"	Sections X9, W and P
3 · Shortcut keys	"Which key starts the slideshow from the current slide?"	Section K tables
4 · Errors & references	"What causes #N/A?" or "What does the formula become after copying?"	Sections X3 and X8

🎯 Priority 1 (must know)

Cell references ($), VLOOKUP, IF, COUNTIF/SUMIF, COUNT vs COUNTA, the error types, text functions, operator precedence

⭐ Priority 2

INDEX/MATCH, rounding functions, date functions, pivot tables, data validation, conditional formatting, the top 30 shortcuts

📌 Priority 3

Word: breaks, TOC, mail merge, track changes. PowerPoint: master, animation vs transition, views. File formats and Windows keys

Best way to prepare

Open Excel (or Google Sheets, where the functions are almost identical), type the sample sheet from Section X2, and **type every example formula yourself**. You'll remember an output you've seen with your own eyes far better than one you only read about.

📗 MICROSOFT EXCEL · THE BIGGEST TOPIC

Excel, Complete

About 5 of the 7 Office questions come from Excel, and most of those ask for the **output of a formula**. Master references, the core functions and the error types, and this section becomes free marks.

References | Functions | Lookups | Errors | Data tools | Pivot & charts

SPEAK THE LANGUAGE

X1 Interface, Terms & File Types

File · Home · Insert · Page Layout · Formulas · Data · Review · View

C3 fx =SUMIF(B2:B7,"IT",C2:C7)

	A	B	C	D
1	Name	Dept	Salary	Exp
2	Asha	HR	40000	2

Term	Meaning
Workbook	The Excel **file**
Worksheet	One **tab or sheet** inside the workbook
Cell	Column letter + row number, like `C3`
Range	A block of cells, like `A1:D7`
Name Box	Shows or jumps to the active cell's address (top left)
Formula bar (fx)	Shows the cell's formula or contents
Active cell	The selected cell, with a thick green border
Fill handle	The small square at the cell's corner. Drag it to copy or fill a series
Ribbon	The tabs and groups of commands at the top

Fact	Value
Rows per sheet (2007+)	**1,048,576**
Columns per sheet	**16,384** (A to **XFD**)
Old .xls limits	65,536 rows × 256 columns (IV)
Characters per cell	32,767
Default new sheet name	Sheet1

Extension	Meaning
`.xlsx`	Standard workbook (no macros)
`.xlsm`	Workbook **with macros** (VBA)
`.xls`	Old 97–2003 format
`.xltx` / `.xltm`	Template / template with macros
`.csv`	Plain text, comma-separated, one sheet, no formatting or formulas

Home
Font, alignment, number format, conditional formatting, cell styles, sort and filter, find

Insert
Tables, PivotTable, charts, sparklines, pictures, links, text box

Page Layout
Themes, margins, orientation, print area, print titles

Formulas
Function library, Name Manager, trace precedents and dependents, show formulas

Data
Sort, filter, text to columns, remove duplicates, data validation, what-if analysis, group

Review
Spelling, comments and notes, protect sheet and workbook

View
Freeze panes, split, zoom, gridlines, page break preview, macros

File (Backstage)
Save, Save As, print, share, export, options

X2

THE BASICS OF EVERY FORMULA

Data Entry, Formulas & Precedence

Numbers vs text
Numbers align **right** by default and text aligns **left**. Typing `'123` (with an apostrophe) stores 123 as **text**.

Dates are numbers
Excel stores a date as a serial number: **1 = 1-Jan-1900**. So you can subtract dates to get days: `="15-Mar-2024"-"1-Mar-2024"` = 14.

Booleans
TRUE and FALSE behave as **1 and 0** in arithmetic: `=TRUE+TRUE` = 2.

AutoFill & Flash Fill. Drag the fill handle to copy or continue a pattern (Mon → Tue → Wed, 1, 3, 5…). **Flash Fill** (`Ctrl+E`) learns a pattern from one or two examples you type, such as extracting first names, and fills the rest.

Formula rules

- Every formula starts with `=`. Functions use the pattern `=NAME(arguments)`, with arguments separated by commas.
- **Reference operators:** `:` range (`A1:A5`) · `,` union (`SUM(A1,C1)`) · **space** intersection (`=B1:B5 A3:D3` gives B3).
- **Text** goes in double quotes: `"HR"`. To join text use `&` : `=A2&" "&B2`.
- Refer to another sheet with `=Sheet2!A1`, or `='Sales Data'!B4` if the name has spaces.

Operator precedence (highest first)

#	Operator	Meaning
1	`: , space`	Reference operators
2	`-`	Negation (unary minus)
3	`%`	Percent (`=50%` = 0.5)
4	`^`	Power
5	`* /`	Multiply, divide (left to right)
6	`+ -`	Add, subtract (left to right)
7	`&`	Join text
8	`= < > <= >= <>`	Comparison (gives TRUE/FALSE)

Formula	Result
`=2+3*4`	14
`=(2+3)*4`	20
`=10/2*5`	25 (left to right)
`=2^3^2`	64, because Excel works left to right: $(2^3)^2$
`=-3^2`	**9**, because negation comes first
`=10-2^2*2`	10 − 8 = 2
`=5&5+1`	"56", because + comes before &
`=3>2`	TRUE

Two famous traps: `=-3^2` gives **9** in Excel (most programming languages give −9), and `=2^3^2` gives **64** (Python gives 512). Excel applies negation before the power and evaluates ^ from left to right.

The sample sheet used throughout this guide

	A	B	C	D
1	**Name**	**Dept**	**Salary**	**Exp**
2	Asha	HR	40000	2
3	Ravi	IT	55000	5
4	Meena	IT	62000	7
5	John	Sales	38000	1
6	Priya	HR	45000	4
7	Arjun	Sales	51000	6

	F	G
1	**Min marks**	**Grade**
2	0	F
3	40	D
4	60	C
5	75	B
6	90	A

Grade table (sorted ascending), used for approximate VLOOKUP

X3

THE MOST-TESTED CONCEPT

Cell References

When you **copy** a formula, Excel shifts its references by the same number of rows and columns you moved it. The `$` sign **locks** the part that comes right after it.

Type	Written	Column	Row	Copy from C2 → E5 (2 columns right, 3 rows down)
Relative	`A1`	moves	moves	`=A1` → `=C4`
Absolute	`$A$1`	locked	locked	`=$A$1` → `=$A$1`
Mixed	`$A1`	locked	moves	`=$A1` → `=$A4`
Mixed	`A$1`	moves	locked	`=A$1` → `=C$1`

The 2-step method for copy questions

1. Count how far the formula moved: columns right or left, rows down or up.
2. Shift every part **without** a `$` by that amount. Leave every part with a `$` unchanged.

Example: `=$B2*C$1` copied from D2 to F4 (+2 columns, +2 rows) → `=$B4*E$1` .

Why it matters: a percentage table

With total sales in **$B$10**, type `=B2/$B$10` in C2 and drag down to C9. Each row divides by the same fixed total.

F4 cycles: `A1` → `$A$1` → `A$1` → `$A1` → `A1` .

Named ranges (Formulas → Name Manager, or type into the Name Box): call `C2:C7` "Salary", then write `=SUM(Salary)` . Names are always absolute. **Tables** (`Ctrl+T`) use structured references like `=SUM(Table1[Salary])` and grow automatically when you add rows.

Trap: moving a formula (cut and paste) does **not** change its references. Only **copying** shifts them. Deleting a referenced row turns the reference into `#REF!` .

CALCULATE

X4 Math & Statistical Functions

Function	Does	Example → result (sample sheet)
`SUM(range)`	Adds numbers (ignores text)	`=SUM(C2:C7)` → 291000
`AVERAGE`	Arithmetic mean	`=AVERAGE(D2:D7)` → 4.1666…
`MEDIAN`	Middle value after sorting	`=MEDIAN(D2:D7)` → 4.5
`MODE`	Most frequent value	`=MODE(1,2,2,3)` → 2
`MAX / MIN`	Largest / smallest	`=MIN(C2:C7)` → 38000
`LARGE / SMALL(range,k)`	k-th largest / smallest	`=SMALL(C2:C7,2)` → 40000
`RANK(value,range,[order])`	Position. 0 or omitted = descending, 1 = ascending	`=RANK(C3,C2:C7)` → 2
`COUNT`	Counts **numeric** cells	`=COUNT(A1:D7)` → 12
`COUNTA`	Counts **non-empty** cells	`=COUNTA(A1:D1)` → 4
`COUNTBLANK`	Counts empty cells	—
`SUMPRODUCT(r1,r2)`	Multiplies pairs, then adds	`=SUMPRODUCT(C2:C3,D2:D3)` → 355000
`ROUND(x,n)`	Rounds to n digits, halves **away from zero**	`=ROUND(3.456,1)` → 3.5 · `=ROUND(1234,-2)` → 1200
`ROUNDUP / ROUNDDOWN`	Always away from / toward zero	`=ROUNDUP(3.21,0)` → 4 · `=ROUNDDOWN(3.99,0)` → 3
`INT(x)`	Rounds **down** to an integer	`=INT(7.9)` → 7 · `=INT(-3.7)` → **-4**
`TRUNC(x)`	Chops off the decimals	`=TRUNC(-3.7)` → **-3**
`MOD(a,b)`	Remainder (takes the sign of b)	`=MOD(17,5)` → 2 · `=MOD(-7,3)` → **2**
`CEILING / FLOOR(x,m)`	Round up / down to a multiple of m	`=CEILING(7,5)` → 10 · `=FLOOR(7,5)` → 5
`ABS · SQRT · POWER`	Absolute value · square root · power	`=POWER(2,10)` → 1024 · `=SQRT(-4)` → #NUM!
`RAND · RANDBETWEEN`	Random 0–1 / random integer	Recalculate on every change (volatile)

INT vs TRUNC: they're the same for positive numbers but different for negatives: `INT(-3.7) = -4` and `TRUNC(-3.7) = -3`. Also, AVERAGE ignores empty cells but **counts zeros**.

DECIDE

X5 Logical & Conditional Functions

IF(logical_test, value_if_true, value_if_false)

`=IF(C3>50000,"High","Low")` → **High** · `=IF(D5>=2,"Eligible","")` → "" (empty text)

Nested: `=IF(C4>=60000,"A",IF(C4>=45000,"B","C"))` → A. Test from the highest condition down.

IFS (2019+): `=IFS(C4>=60000,"A",C4>=45000,"B",TRUE,"C")`, with no nesting needed.

AND(...)
TRUE only if **all** are TRUE
`=AND(B3="IT",D3>=5)` → TRUE

OR(...)
TRUE if **any** is TRUE
`=OR(B5="HR",D5>3)` → FALSE

NOT(...)
Reverses TRUE/FALSE
`=NOT(B2="HR")` → FALSE

IFERROR(value, value_if_error): `=IFERROR(C2/0,"NA")` → NA. **IFNA** catches only #N/A.

COUNTIF · SUMIF · AVERAGEIF and their -IFS forms

Syntax	Example → result
`COUNTIF(range, criteria)`	`=COUNTIF(B2:B7,"IT")` → 2
`SUMIF(range, criteria, [sum_range])`	`=SUMIF(B2:B7,"HR",C2:C7)` → 85000
`AVERAGEIF(range, criteria, [avg_range])`	`=AVERAGEIF(B2:B7,"Sales",C2:C7)` → 44500
`COUNTIFS(r1,c1, r2,c2, …)`	`=COUNTIFS(B2:B7,"IT",D2:D7,">5")` → 1
`SUMIFS(sum_range, r1,c1, r2,c2, …)`	`=SUMIFS(C2:C7,B2:B7,"HR",D2:D7,">=3")` → 45000

Criteria	Matches
`"IT"` or `"it"`	equal to IT (not case-sensitive)
`">50000"`	greater than 50000
`"<>HR"`	not equal to HR
`"A*"`	starts with A (`*` = any characters)
`"?ohn"`	any 1 character + ohn (`?` = one character)
`">"&F1`	greater than the value in F1
`"*"`	any text cell

Argument-order trap: in SUMIF the **sum_range comes last**, but in SUMIFS the **sum_range comes first**. This is a favourite exam trick.

The comparison operator goes **inside the quotes**, and a cell reference is joined with `&` : `">="&F1`.

X6

FIND AND FETCH

Lookup Functions

VLOOKUP(lookup_value, table_array, col_index_num, [range_lookup])

1. It searches for *lookup_value* in the **first column** of *table_array*.
2. It goes across that row to column number *col_index_num*, counted **within the table** starting from 1.
3. `FALSE` / `0` = **exact** match (use this almost always). `TRUE` /omitted = **approximate** match, which returns the largest value ≤ the lookup value and needs the first column **sorted ascending**.

`=VLOOKUP("Priya",A2:D7,2,FALSE)` → HR · `=VLOOKUP("Priya",A2:D7,3,FALSE)` → 45000 · `=VLOOKUP(78,F2:G6,2,TRUE)` → B

VLOOKUP limits: (1) It only looks to the **right**. (2) `col_index_num` = 0 gives #VALUE!, and a number bigger than the table width gives **#REF!**. (3) A value that isn't found gives **#N/A**. (4) It returns only the **first** match. (5) Leaving out FALSE on unsorted data can give wrong answers silently.

HLOOKUP
The horizontal version: it searches the first **row** and returns from row number n.
`=HLOOKUP("Exp",A1:D7,3,FALSE)` → 5

MATCH(value, range, [type])
Returns the **position** of the value. 0 = exact, 1 = largest ≤ (ascending), −1 = smallest ≥ (descending).
`=MATCH("John",A2:A7,0)` → 4

INDEX(range, row, [col])
Returns the value at a position.
`=INDEX(A2:D7,3,1)` → Meena

INDEX + MATCH (it can look left)
`=INDEX(A2:A7,MATCH(51000,C2:C7,0))` → Arjun

XLOOKUP (Excel 365/2021)
`=XLOOKUP("Ravi",A2:A7,C2:C7,"Not found")` → 55000. Exact by default, looks in any direction, and has a built-in "not found" value.

CHOOSE(index, v1, v2, ...)
`=CHOOSE(2,"Red","Green","Blue")` → Green

X7

WORDS AND DATES

Text & Date Functions

Function	Does	Example → result
`LEN(text)`	Number of characters (spaces count)	`=LEN("MS Office")` → 9
`LEFT(text,n) / RIGHT(text,n)`	First / last n characters	`=LEFT("Accenture",3)` → Acc
`MID(text,start,n)`	n characters from position start	`=MID("Accenture",3,4)` → cent
`FIND(find,text,[start])`	Position: **case-sensitive**, no wildcards	`=FIND("e","Excel")` → 4
`SEARCH(find,text,[start])`	Position: **not case-sensitive**, wildcards allowed	`=SEARCH("e","Excel")` → 1
`UPPER / LOWER / PROPER`	Change case	`=PROPER("ravi KUMAR")` → Ravi Kumar
`TRIM(text)`	Removes extra spaces (keeps single spaces between words)	`=TRIM(" a b ")` → "a b"
`&` / `CONCAT` / `CONCATENATE`	Join text	`=CONCAT(A2,"-",B2)` → Asha-HR
`TEXTJOIN(delim,ignore_empty,…)`	Join with a separator	`=TEXTJOIN(", ",TRUE,A2:A4)` → Asha, Ravi, Meena
`SUBSTITUTE(text,old,new)`	Replace by **content**	`=SUBSTITUTE("a-b-c","-","")` → abc
`REPLACE(text,start,n,new)`	Replace by **position**	`=REPLACE("2023",4,1,"4")` → 2024
`REPT(text,n)`	Repeat text	`=REPT("*",3)` → ***
`TEXT(value,format)`	Number → formatted text	`=TEXT(1234.5,"#,##0.00")` → 1,234.50
`VALUE(text)`	Text → number	`=VALUE("42")+1` → 43
`EXACT(a,b)`	Case-sensitive comparison	`=EXACT("IT","it")` → FALSE

Date function	Does	Example → result
`TODAY() / NOW()`	Current date / date + time (volatile)	`Ctrl+;` inserts a **fixed** date
`DATE(y,m,d)`	Builds a date	`=DATE(2026,7,31)` → 31-Jul-2026
`YEAR / MONTH / DAY`	Extract parts	`=MONTH("15-Mar-2024")` → 3
`WEEKDAY(date)`	Day number (default: **Sunday = 1**)	A Monday → 2
`DATEDIF(start,end,"Y"/"M"/"D")`	Complete years / months / days between	`=DATEDIF("1-Jan-2020","15-Mar-2024","Y")` → 4
`EDATE(date,months)`	Same day n months later	`=EDATE("31-Jan-2024",1)` → 29-Feb-2024
`NETWORKDAYS(start,end)`	Working days (Mon–Fri) between dates	Holidays can be excluded

WHEN THINGS BREAK

X8

Errors & Formula Auditing

Error	Meaning	Typical cause / example
`#DIV/0!`	Division by zero	`=A1/0`, or dividing by an empty cell
`#N/A`	Value not available	VLOOKUP, MATCH or XLOOKUP can't find the value
`#VALUE!`	Wrong type of argument	`="abc"*2`
`#REF!`	Invalid reference	A referenced row or column was deleted, or the VLOOKUP column index is too large
`#NAME?`	Unrecognised name	`=SUMM(A1:A3)`, text without quotes, or an undefined named range
`#NUM!`	Invalid number	`=SQRT(-1)`, or a result too large
`#NULL!`	Ranges don't intersect	A space used instead of a comma: `=SUM(A1:A3 C1:C3)`
`#SPILL!`	Dynamic array blocked	A formula's result range isn't empty (Excel 365)
`####`	Not an error	The column is too narrow, or a date/time is negative

Trace Precedents / Dependents
Arrows showing which cells **feed** a formula, and which cells **use** it (Formulas tab).

Evaluate Formula
Steps through a formula one part at a time, which is great for debugging nested IFs.

Circular reference
A formula that refers to its own cell, directly or indirectly. Excel shows a warning.

WORK WITH DATA

X9

Data Tools, Pivots, Charts & Printing

Sort reorders rows: A→Z, Z→A, by colour, or by several levels (for example Dept, then Salary). Always select the whole table so rows stay together.

Filter (`Ctrl+Shift+L`) **hides** rows that don't match. Nothing is deleted. Advanced Filter can copy matching rows somewhere else.

Remove Duplicates deletes repeated rows, based on the columns you choose.

Text to Columns splits one column into several using a delimiter (comma or space) or a fixed width. Example: "Ravi Kumar" → "Ravi" | "Kumar".

Data Validation limits what can be typed: a list (drop-down), whole number between 1 and 100, dates, text length. It can show an input message and an error alert.

Conditional Formatting changes a cell's *look* based on its value: highlight rules (> 50000), top/bottom 10, data bars, colour scales, icon sets, duplicates.

Freeze Panes keeps headers visible while scrolling. **Split** divides the window into separately scrollable panes.

Group / Subtotal collapses detail rows (outline), and Subtotal inserts totals for each group of sorted data.

What-If Analysis

Goal Seek
"What **input** gives this **result**?" For example, which loan amount gives an EMI of ₹10,000. One variable.

Scenario Manager
Saves and compares sets of inputs: best case, worst case and expected case.

Data Table
Shows results for many input values at once (one or two variables). **Solver** (an add-in) optimises with constraints.

Pivot Tables

A pivot table summarises big data **without formulas**. Insert → PivotTable, then drag fields into four areas:

Area	Purpose
Rows	Categories down the side (Dept)
Columns	Categories across the top
Values	Numbers to summarise (Sum of Salary)
Filters	Filter the whole pivot

PivotTable: Rows = Dept, Values = Sum of Salary

Dept	Sum of Salary
HR	85000
IT	117000
Sales	89000
Grand Total	**291000**

Values can show Sum, Count, Average, Max, Min or % of total. A pivot needs **Refresh** after the source data changes. Slicers are visual filter buttons.

Charts: pick the right one

Chart	Best for	Chart	Best for
Column / Bar	Comparing categories	**Pie / Doughnut**	Parts of a whole (100%)
Line	Trends over time	**Scatter (XY)**	Relationship between two variables
Area	Volume or trend over time	**Histogram**	Frequency distribution
Combo	Two measures, for example columns + a line on a secondary axis	**Sparklines**	A tiny chart inside one cell

`F11` creates a chart on a **new sheet**. `Alt+F1` creates an embedded chart on the same sheet. Chart parts: title, axes, legend, data labels, gridlines, plot area.

Formatting, protection & printing

Number formats (`Ctrl+1`)
General, Number, Currency, Accounting, Date, Percentage, Fraction, Scientific, Text, Custom (`#,##0.00`). Formatting changes the **display only**, not the stored value.

Alignment
Wrap Text, Merge & Center, orientation, indent. `Alt+Enter` adds a line break inside a cell.

Protection
Protect Sheet locks cells from editing (Review tab). **Protect Workbook** locks the structure (adding or deleting sheets). Encrypt the file with a password through File → Info.

Printing
Set Print Area, **Print Titles** (repeat header rows on every page), Page Break Preview, Fit to 1 page, orientation and margins.

Comments vs Notes
Comments are threaded conversations. Notes are simple yellow sticky notes (the classic "comment").

Macros
Recorded or VBA automation of repeated tasks (View or Developer tab). The file must be saved as **.xlsm**. `Alt+F11` opens the VBA editor.

MICROSOFT WORD

Word, Complete

Expect about one question on formatting, page layout, references (TOC, footnotes), mail merge or reviewing. Learn which **tab** each feature lives on, and the key shortcuts.

Formatting | Styles | Breaks | TOC & references | Mail merge | Review

Home
Font, paragraph, styles, Find and Replace, Format Painter, bullets and numbering

Insert
Page break, table, pictures, shapes, SmartArt, chart, header and footer, page numbers, text box, equation, symbol, hyperlink

Design / Layout
Themes, **watermark**, page colour, borders · margins, orientation, size, columns, **breaks**, line numbers

References
Table of Contents, footnotes and endnotes, citations and bibliography, captions, index

Mailings
Mail merge, envelopes, labels

Review
Spelling and grammar (F7), word count, comments, **Track Changes**, compare, protect

View
Read Mode, Print Layout, Web Layout, Outline, Draft, navigation pane, ruler, zoom

File
Save As (PDF), print, info (protect document), export

W1

MAKE IT LOOK RIGHT

Formatting, Styles & Page Layout

Character formatting

Font, size, **bold** (Ctrl+B), *italic* (Ctrl+I), underline (Ctrl+U), strikethrough, sub$_{script}$ (Ctrl+=), super^{script} (Ctrl+Shift+=), highlight, font colour, change case (Shift+F3), clear formatting.

Paragraph formatting

Alignment: left (Ctrl+L), centre (Ctrl+E), right (Ctrl+R), justify (Ctrl+J). Line spacing: 1.0 (Ctrl+1), 1.5 (Ctrl+5), 2.0 (Ctrl+2). Indents: first-line, hanging, left and right. Spacing before and after, borders, shading.

Styles & themes

A **style** is a saved set of formatting (Normal, Heading 1…). Change the style once and every paragraph using it updates. Heading styles drive the **Navigation Pane** and the **TOC**.

Format Painter

Copies formatting from one piece of text to another. A single click applies it once, a double click keeps it on until Esc. Ctrl+Shift+C / Ctrl+Shift+V copy and paste formatting.

Break	What it does
Page break (Ctrl+Enter)	The following text starts on a new page
Column break	The following text moves to the next column (in a multi-column layout)
Text wrapping / line break (Shift+Enter)	A new line in the **same paragraph**

Break	What it does
Section break: Next Page, Continuous, Even, Odd	Starts a new **section** that can have its own orientation, margins, headers, footers, page numbering and columns. Example: one landscape page in a portrait document.

Header / Footer
Repeats on every page: titles and **page numbers**. Options include "Different first page" and "Different odd and even".

Columns & Drop Cap
Newspaper-style columns (Layout tab). A drop cap is a large first letter (Insert tab).

Watermark
Faint text or an image behind the content, like "CONFIDENTIAL" or "DRAFT" (Design tab).

W2

LONG DOCUMENTS

Tables, References & Mail Merge

Tables
Insert → Table. You can merge and split cells, repeat the header row, and sort. Insert → Table → **Convert Text to Table** uses a separator such as a tab or comma. Formulas: Layout → Formula → `=SUM(ABOVE)` (also LEFT, RIGHT, BELOW).

Table of Contents
Built automatically from **Heading styles** (References tab). Use **Update Table** after editing.

Footnote vs Endnote
A footnote appears at the **bottom of the same page** (Alt+Ctrl+F). An endnote appears at the **end of the document or section** (Alt+Ctrl+D).

Captions, Citations, Index
Captions number figures and tables ("Figure 1"). Citations plus a bibliography handle references in APA, MLA and other styles. An index lists marked terms with page numbers.

Mail Merge: one template, many personalised documents

1. **Start Mail Merge:** choose letters, emails, envelopes, labels or a directory.
2. **Select Recipients:** type a list, use an Excel sheet, or use Outlook contacts.
3. **Insert Merge Fields** like «Name» and «City» into the main document.
4. **Preview Results**, then **Finish & Merge**: edit, print or send emails.

The main document holds the fixed text, and the data source holds the varying data.

W3

COLLABORATE & VIEW

Review, Views & File Types

Track Changes (Ctrl+Shift+E)
Records insertions and deletions so they can be **accepted or rejected**. **Compare** shows the differences between two versions.

Comments (Ctrl+Alt+M)
Notes in the margin. Spelling and grammar (**F7**), Thesaurus (Shift+F7), word count.

Protect / Restrict Editing
Read-only, allow only comments, allow only form filling, or require a password to open.

View	Use
Print Layout	Default: shows the document as it will print
Read Mode	Comfortable reading, no editing tools
Web Layout	As a web page (no page breaks)
Outline	Structure by heading levels, for reorganising
Draft	Plain text only, with no headers or images

File	Meaning
`.docx`	Standard document
`.doc`	Old 97–2003 format
`.dotx` / `.docm`	Template / with macros
`.pdf`	Fixed layout (File → Save As / Export)
`.rtf` / `.txt`	Rich text / plain text

Also know: Find & Replace (Ctrl+H) can replace formatting and special characters. AutoCorrect fixes typos as you type. A **hyperlink** (Ctrl+K) can jump to a website or to a **bookmark** in the document. SmartArt makes diagrams from lists. Wrap Text sets how an image sits relative to text (in line, square, tight, behind or in front).

📙 MICROSOFT POWERPOINT

PowerPoint, Complete

Expect about one question on masters, animation vs transition, views, slideshow keys or file types.

Slide Master · Layouts & themes · Animations · Transitions · Views · Slideshow

Slide Master (View → Slide Master)
The top slide controls the theme, fonts, colours, logo and placeholders of **every** slide. The **layouts** under it (Title, Title and Content, Section Header…) control each type of slide. Change it once and every slide updates.

Themes & Designer
A theme is a set of colours, fonts and effects (Design tab). Designer / Design Ideas suggests professional layouts automatically. Slide size: 16:9 (default) or 4:3.

	Animation	Transition
Applies to	An **object** on a slide (text, image, shape, chart)	The **change from one slide to the next**
Tab	Animations (plus the Animation Pane)	Transitions
Types	**Entrance** (green), **Emphasis** (yellow), **Exit** (red), **Motion Paths**	Fade, Push, Wipe, Morph, Cut…
Options	Start: On Click / With Previous / After Previous · Duration · Delay · **Trigger** (start when an object is clicked)	Duration, sound, advance on mouse click or after a set time, **Apply to All**

View	Use
Normal	Editing: thumbnails + slide + notes
Outline	Edit the text of all slides as an outline
Slide Sorter	Thumbnails: **reorder**, duplicate, hide slides
Notes Page	Slide + speaker notes, for printing

During a slideshow	Key
Start from the beginning / current slide	`F5` / `Shift+F5`
Next / previous	`N`, `Space`, `→` / `P`, `←`
Black / white screen	`B` / `W`

View	Use
Reading View	Show inside the window
Presenter View	The presenter sees notes, the next slide and a timer, while the audience sees only the slide

During a slideshow	Key
Go to slide 5	`5` then `Enter`
Pen / laser pointer	`Ctrl+P` / `Ctrl+L`
End the show	`Esc`

Rehearse Timings
Practise the talk and save how long each slide is shown, so the show can run automatically.

Hide Slide
Keeps the slide in the file but skips it during the show.

Sections
Group slides into named sections to organise large decks.

Handouts
Printed pages with 1–9 slides each (Handout Master).

Record Slide Show
Records narration and timings. It can be exported as a video (MP4).

Morph
A transition that smoothly animates objects between two similar slides.

File	Meaning	File	Meaning
`.pptx`	Standard presentation	`.ppsx`	Opens **directly as a slideshow**
`.potx`	Template	`.pptm`	With macros
`.ppt`	Old 97–2003 format	Export	PDF, MP4 video, images (PNG/JPG)

✉ COMMON APPLICATIONS

Outlook, Windows & File Formats

"Common applications" can include email etiquette and options, operating-system basics, file types and the other Office apps.

Outlook / email

Field / action	Meaning
To	Main recipients who are expected to act
CC (carbon copy)	Kept informed. Everyone can see CC addresses
BCC (blind CC)	**Hidden** from all other recipients
Reply	Only to the sender
Reply All	To the sender and everyone in To and CC (not BCC)
Forward	Sends the message, with its attachments, to new people
Rules · Signature · Out of Office	Auto-sort mail · auto sign-off · automatic replies

Other Office & cloud apps

App	Used for
Access	Relational **database**: tables, queries, forms, reports
OneNote	Digital notebook
Teams	Chat, meetings, collaboration
OneDrive	Personal cloud storage and file sync
SharePoint	Team sites, document libraries, intranet
Publisher / Visio	Desktop publishing / diagrams and flowcharts
Google equivalents	Docs (Word), Sheets (Excel), Slides (PowerPoint), Drive (OneDrive)

Field / action	Meaning
Calendar · Meeting request	Schedule a meeting, invite attendees, track Accept, Tentative or Decline

File extensions to recognise

Extension	Type	Extension	Type	Extension	Type
`.txt`	Plain text	`.jpg / .png`	Image (lossy / lossless)	`.zip / .rar`	Compressed archive
`.pdf`	Portable document	`.gif / .svg`	Animated / vector image	`.exe / .msi`	Windows program / installer
`.csv`	Comma-separated values	`.mp3 / .wav`	Audio	`.html`	Web page
`.rtf`	Rich text	`.mp4 / .avi`	Video	`.accdb`	Access database

Clipboard
Temporary storage for cut and copied items. `Win+V` shows clipboard history in Windows 10/11.

Save vs Save As
Save overwrites the current file. Save As (`F12`) creates a new name, location or format.

AutoSave / AutoRecover
AutoSave saves continuously to OneDrive. AutoRecover keeps backup copies after a crash.

K

MEMORISE THE TOP ONES

Mega Shortcut Tables

Universal (all Office apps)	
`Ctrl+N / O / S / P`	New / Open / Save / Print
`Ctrl+W` / `Alt+F4`	Close document / close app
`Ctrl+C / X / V`	Copy / Cut / Paste
`Ctrl+Z / Y`	Undo / Redo (or repeat)
`Ctrl+A`	Select all
`Ctrl+B / I / U`	Bold / Italic / Underline
`Ctrl+F / H`	Find / Replace
`Ctrl+K`	Insert hyperlink
`F7`	Spelling check
`F12`	Save As
`F1`	Help
`Alt`	Show ribbon key tips

Word	
`Ctrl+E / L / R / J`	Centre / Left / Right / Justify
`Ctrl+1 / 5 / 2`	Line spacing 1 / 1.5 / 2
`Ctrl+Enter`	Page break
`Shift+Enter`	Line break (same paragraph)
`Shift+F3`	Change case
`Ctrl+] / Ctrl+[`	Increase / decrease font size
`Ctrl+= / Ctrl+Shift+=`	Subscript / superscript
`Ctrl+Shift+C / V`	Copy / paste formatting
`Ctrl+Space` / `Ctrl+Q`	Clear character / paragraph formatting
`Ctrl+M / Ctrl+T`	Indent / hanging indent
`Ctrl+Alt+1/2/3`	Heading 1 / 2 / 3
`Ctrl+Home / End`	Start / end of document
`Ctrl+Shift+E`	Track Changes on/off
`Alt+Ctrl+F / D`	Footnote / endnote
`Shift+F7`	Thesaurus

Outlook	
`Ctrl+Shift+M`	New message (from anywhere)
`Ctrl+R` / `Ctrl+Shift+R`	Reply / Reply All
`Ctrl+F`	Forward (in Outlook, not Find)
`F9`	Send / receive all

Excel	
`F2`	Edit active cell
`F4`	Toggle $ / repeat last action
`Ctrl+1`	Format Cells dialog
`Ctrl+``	Show formulas
`Alt+=`	AutoSum
`Ctrl+;` / `Ctrl+Shift+;`	Insert date / time
`Ctrl+D / Ctrl+R`	Fill down / right
`Ctrl+T`	Create Table
`Ctrl+Shift+L`	Toggle filter
`Ctrl+E`	Flash Fill
`Ctrl+Arrow` / `Ctrl+Home`	Jump to data edge / to A1
`Ctrl+Space` / `Shift+Space`	Select column / row
`Ctrl++` / `Ctrl+-`	Insert / delete cells
`Ctrl+9` / `Ctrl+0`	Hide rows / columns
`Ctrl+PgUp/PgDn`	Previous / next sheet
`Shift+F11`	Insert new worksheet
`F11` / `Alt+F1`	Chart on new sheet / embedded chart
`Alt+Enter`	New line inside a cell
`Ctrl+Shift+$ / %`	Currency / percent format
`F9`	Recalculate
`Alt+F11`	VBA editor

PowerPoint	
`Ctrl+M`	New slide
`Ctrl+D`	Duplicate slide or object
`F5 / Shift+F5`	Show from start / from current slide
`Alt+F5`	Presenter View
`B / W`	Black / white screen (in the show)
`Ctrl+G / Ctrl+Shift+G`	Group / ungroup objects
`Esc`	End the slideshow

Windows	
`Win+D` / `Win+E`	Show desktop / File Explorer
`Win+L`	Lock PC
`Win+R` / `Win+I`	Run box / Settings
`Alt+Tab` / `Win+Tab`	Switch apps / Task View
`Ctrl+Shift+Esc`	Task Manager
`Win+Shift+S`	Screenshot of an area
`Win+V`	Clipboard history
`F2` (Explorer)	Rename file
`Shift+Del`	Delete permanently (skips the Recycle Bin)

FORMULA OUTPUT QUESTIONS

✓1 Practice Set 1 · Excel Outputs

These use the **sample sheet in Section X2** (A1:D7, Name / Dept / Salary / Exp) and the grade table (F2:G6). **Every answer was computed in code from the sheet.** Aim for under 40 seconds each.

E1 Output — What does `=COUNTIF(B2:B7,"Sales")` return?

A 89000
B 1
C 2
D 3

E2 Output — What does `=SUMIFS(C2:C7,B2:B7,"IT",D2:D7,">5")` return?

A 117000
B 55000
C 0
D 62000

E3 Output — What does `=AVERAGEIF(B2:B7,"HR",C2:C7)` return?

A 85000
B 42500
C 40000
D 45000

E4 Output — What does `=COUNTIF(C2:C7,">=50000")` return?

A 6
B 4
C 3
D 2

E5 Output — What does `=VLOOKUP("John",A2:D7,4,FALSE)` return?

A Sales
B 1
C 38000
D #N/A

E6 Output — What does `=INDEX(A2:A7,MATCH(MAX(C2:C7),C2:C7,0))` return?

A Arjun
B 4
C Meena
D 62000

E7 Output — What does `=LARGE(C2:C7,2)` return?

A 62000
B 38000
C 51000
D 55000

E8 Output — What does `=RANK(C6,C2:C7)` return?

A 5
B 4
C 2
D 3

E9 Output — What does `=SUMPRODUCT(C2:C3,D2:D3)` return?

A 95000
B 7
C 355000
D 665000

E10 Output — What does `=IF(AND(B3="IT",D3>=5),"Senior","Junior")` return?

A Junior
B #VALUE!
C TRUE
D Senior

E11 Output — What does `=COUNTIF(A2:A7,"A*")` return?

A 0
B 2
C 1
D 6

E12 Output — What does `=LEN(A4)&"-"&UPPER(B5)` return?

A 10
B 5-Sales
C Meena-SALES
D 5-SALES

E13 Output — What does `=MEDIAN(D2:D7)` return?

A 25
B 5
C 4.5
D 4

E14 Output — What does `=VLOOKUP(78,F2:G6,2,TRUE)` return?

A C
B #N/A
C B
D A

E15 Output — What does `=MOD(-7,3)` return?

A -1
B -2
C 1
D 2

E16 Output — What does `=ROUND(-2.5,0)` return?

A -3
B -2
C 2
D 3

E17 Output — What does `=TRUNC(-3.7)` return?

A -3
B 3
C -4
D -3.7

E18 Output — What does `=FIND("e","Excel")` return?

A #VALUE!
B 4
C 1
D 2

E19 Output — What does `=SUBSTITUTE("2024-25","-","/")` return?

A #NAME?
B 2024/25
C 2024/-25
D 2024-25

E20 Output What does `=TEXT(0.256,"0.0%")` return?

A 0.256
B 0.3%
C 26%
D 25.6%

E21 Output What does `=DATEDIF("01-Jan-2020","15-Mar-2024","Y")` return?

A 4
B 3
C 5
D 50

E22 Output What does `=TRUE+TRUE+FALSE` return?

A TRUE
B 2
C 1
D #VALUE!

E23 Output What does `=-3^2` return?

A #NUM!
B -9
C 6
D 9

E24 Output What does `=COUNT(A1:D7)` return?

A 6
B 12
C 24
D 28

E25 Output What does `=COUNTA(A1:A7)` return?

A 1
B 7
C 6
D 0

E26 Output What does `=PROPER("mS oFFICE")` return?

A mS Office
B MS OFFICE
C ms office
D Ms Office

E27 Output What does `=CONCAT(LEFT(A3,3),RIGHT(A6,2))` return?

A Ravya
B RaviPriya
C Raya
D Rav-ya

E28 Output What does `=IFERROR(VLOOKUP("Zara",A2:D7,2,FALSE),"Not found")` return?

A Not found
B #N/A
C 0
D Zara

Set 1 · Answer key

Q	Ans	Correct option	Why
E1	C	2	It counts the cells in B2:B7 equal to Sales: John and Arjun.
E2	D	62000	Both conditions must be true. Ravi has exactly 5 years, which is not >5, so only Meena's 62000 is added.

Q	Ans	Correct option	Why
E3	**B**	42500	(40000 + 45000) ÷ 2.
E4	**C**	3	55000, 62000 and 51000 are ≥ 50000.
E5	**B**	1	It finds John in column A and returns column 4 of the range (Exp).
E6	**C**	Meena	MAX finds 62000, MATCH gives its position (3) and INDEX returns the 3rd name. This is the classic "who has the highest" pattern.
E7	**D**	55000	LARGE(range, 2) returns the second-highest value.
E8	**B**	4	RANK is descending by default: 62000 is 1st, 55000 2nd, 51000 3rd and 45000 4th.
E9	**C**	355000	40000×2 + 55000×5 = 80000 + 275000.
E10	**D**	Senior	Ravi is in IT and has 5 years (≥ 5), so both conditions are TRUE.
E11	**B**	2	* is a wildcard for any characters, so this counts names starting with A: Asha and Arjun.
E12	**D**	5-SALES	LEN("Meena") = 5, UPPER("Sales") = SALES, and & joins them.
E13	**C**	4.5	Sorted: 1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 7. With an even count, the median is the average of the middle two: (4 + 5) ÷ 2.
E14	**C**	B	Approximate match finds the largest threshold ≤ 78, which is 75, so the grade is B.
E15	**D**	2	Excel's MOD takes the sign of the divisor: -7 = 3 × (-3) + 2.
E16	**A**	-3	Excel rounds halves away from zero, so -2.5 becomes -3.
E17	**A**	-3	TRUNC just chops off the decimals. INT(-3.7) would give -4, because INT rounds down.
E18	**B**	4	FIND is case-sensitive, so it skips the capital E and finds the lowercase e at position 4. SEARCH would return 1.
E19	**B**	2024/25	SUBSTITUTE swaps the old text for the new text.
E20	**D**	25.6%	The format code 0.0% multiplies by 100 and shows one decimal place.
E21	**A**	4	"Y" counts the complete years between the two dates.
E22	**B**	2	In arithmetic, TRUE = 1 and FALSE = 0.
E23	**D**	9	Excel applies negation before the power: $(-3)^2 = 9$. Write =-(3^2) to get -9.
E24	**B**	12	COUNT counts only numeric cells: 6 salaries + 6 experience values. Headers and names are text.
E25	**B**	7	COUNTA counts every non-empty cell, including the header.
E26	**D**	Ms Office	PROPER capitalises the first letter of each word and lowercases the rest.
E27	**A**	Ravya	LEFT("Ravi", 3) = Rav and RIGHT("Priya", 2) = ya.
E28	**A**	Not found	Zara isn't in the list, so VLOOKUP returns #N/A, and IFERROR replaces it with the fallback text.

FEATURES, WORD, POWERPOINT & APPS

Practice Set 2 · Concepts & Shortcuts

Excel concepts

X1 Excel **You copy `=$A1+B$1` from cell C2 to cell D3. What does D3 contain?**

A =$B2+C$2
B =$A1+B$1
C =$A2+B$1
D =$A2+C$1

X2 Excel **How many rows does an Excel 2007+ worksheet have?**

A 65,536
B 1,048,576
C 16,384
D 1,000,000

X3 Excel **Which file extension saves an Excel workbook WITH macros?**

A .xltx
B .xlsx
C .csv
D .xlsm

X4 Excel **Which shortcut shows the formulas in cells instead of their results?**

A Ctrl + `
B F9
C Ctrl + F3
D Ctrl + Shift + F

X5 Excel **You want rows 1–3 to stay visible while you scroll down. Use:**

A Group
B Split
C Freeze Panes
D Wrap Text

X6 Excel **Which tool finds the INPUT value needed to reach a target result?**

A Pivot Table
B Data Validation
C Goal Seek
D Flash Fill

X7 Excel **Which feature restricts a cell to values from a drop-down list?**

A Conditional Formatting
B AutoFilter
C Data Validation
D Protect Sheet

X8 Excel **To summarise sales by region and month without writing formulas, use a:**

A Sparkline
B Hyperlink
C Pivot Table
D Macro

X9 Excel **A cell displays ##### . The most likely reason is:**

A The column is too narrow
B Invalid reference
C Division by zero
D Misspelt function

X10 Excel **Which function is case-INSENSITIVE and supports wildcards?**

A EXACT
B FIND
C MID
D SEARCH

X11 Excel **A formula refers to its own cell, directly or indirectly. Excel reports a:**

A Circular reference
B #REF! error
C #SPILL! error
D Volatile function

X12 Excel **Which chart best shows parts of a whole (100%)?**

A Pie chart
B Scatter chart
C Histogram
D Line chart

Word

W1 Word **Which break lets ONE page of a document be landscape while the rest stay portrait?**

A Section break (Next Page)
B Column break
C Page break
D Text wrapping break

W2 Word **An automatic Table of Contents is built from:**

A Footnotes
B Bookmarks only
C Heading styles (Heading 1, 2, 3...)
D Bold text

W3 Word **Notes that appear at the bottom of the SAME page are:**

A Captions
B Comments
C Footnotes
D Endnotes

W4 Word **Which shortcut cycles selected text between UPPER, lower and Title case?**

A Alt + F3
B Ctrl + Shift + A
C Shift + F3
D Ctrl + F3

W5 Word **Copying only the FORMATTING of text to other text is done with:**

A Format Painter
B Styles Pane
C Clear Formatting
D Paste Special → Text

W6 Word **Which tab contains Mail Merge?**

A Review
B References
C Insert
D Mailings

W7 Word **Which feature records every edit so a reviewer can accept or reject it?**

A Track Changes
B Compare
C Version History
D Protect Document

W8 Word — In a Word table, which formula adds the numbers in the cells above?

A =ADD(ABOVE)
B =SUM(ABOVE)
C =TOTAL(COLUMN)
D =SUM(UP)

W9 Word — Which shortcut sets double line spacing?

A Ctrl + 2
B Ctrl + D
C Ctrl + Shift + 2
D Alt + 2

PowerPoint

P1 PowerPoint — You need the same logo on every slide. The best place to add it is:

A Slide Master
B Notes Master
C Each slide individually
D Handout Master

P2 PowerPoint — During a slideshow, which key turns the screen black?

A K
B Esc
C W
D B

P3 PowerPoint — An effect applied when moving FROM one slide TO the next is a:

A Animation
B Trigger
C Motion path
D Transition

P4 PowerPoint — Which file format opens a presentation directly in slideshow mode?

A .potx
B .ppsx
C .pptm
D .pptx

P5 PowerPoint — Which view is best for re-ordering many slides at once?

A Notes Page
B Outline only
C Reading View
D Slide Sorter

P6 PowerPoint — Which feature practises the talk and saves how long each slide is shown?

A Record Narration only
B Hide Slide
C Slide Master
D Rehearse Timings

Common applications

O1 Common apps — Recipients in which field are HIDDEN from all other recipients?

A To
B Reply-To
C CC
D BCC

O2 Common apps — Which shortcut opens Task Manager directly in Windows?

A Win + T
B Ctrl + Alt + T
C Alt + F4
D Ctrl + Shift + Esc

03 Common apps **Which shortcut locks a Windows PC immediately?**

A Win + L
B Alt + L
C Ctrl + L
D Win + D

04 Common apps **A .csv file stores:**

A Plain-text values separated by commas (one sheet, no formatting)
B Formulas and charts
C Images
D Macros

05 Common apps **Which shortcut takes a screenshot of a selected area in Windows 10/11?**

A Ctrl + PrtSc
B Alt + S
C Win + Shift + S
D Win + P

Set 2 · Answer key

Q	Ans	Correct option	Why
X1	**D**	=$A2+C$1	$A keeps the column fixed but the row moves (1 → 2). B$1 keeps the row fixed but the column moves (B → C).
X2	**B**	1,048,576	1,048,576 rows × 16,384 columns (A to XFD). 65,536 was the old .xls limit.
X3	**D**	.xlsm	.xlsx can't store macros. .xltx is a template and .csv is plain text with only one sheet.
X4	**A**	Ctrl + `	Ctrl + ` (the grave accent) toggles formula view.
X5	**C**	Freeze Panes	View → Freeze Panes.
X6	**C**	Goal Seek	Data → What-If Analysis → Goal Seek.
X7	**C**	Data Validation	Data Validation → Allow: List.
X8	**C**	Pivot Table	A pivot table drags fields into Rows, Columns, Values and Filters.
X9	**A**	The column is too narrow	Widen the column. It isn't a real error.
X10	**D**	SEARCH	FIND is case-sensitive and doesn't support wildcards.
X11	**A**	Circular reference	Formulas → Error Checking → Circular References.
X12	**A**	Pie chart	A line chart shows trends over time, and a scatter chart shows relationships.
W1	**A**	Section break (Next Page)	Orientation, margins, headers and footers can differ by section.
W2	**C**	Heading styles (Heading 1, 2, 3...)	References → Table of Contents reads the heading styles.
W3	**C**	Footnotes	Endnotes appear at the end of the document or section.
W4	**C**	Shift + F3	Ctrl + Shift + A applies All Caps formatting, which is a different feature.
W5	**A**	Format Painter	Single-click applies it once, and double-click keeps it on.
W6	**D**	Mailings	Mailings → Start Mail Merge → Select Recipients → Insert Merge Field → Finish & Merge.

Q	Ans	Correct option	Why
W7	**A**	Track Changes	Review → Track Changes.
W8	**B**	=SUM(ABOVE)	Layout → Formula. LEFT, RIGHT and BELOW also work.
W9	**A**	Ctrl + 2	Ctrl + 1 = single, Ctrl + 5 = 1.5, Ctrl + 2 = double.
P1	**A**	Slide Master	View → Slide Master. Every slide based on it inherits the logo.
P2	**D**	B	Press it again to return. W gives a white screen.
P3	**D**	Transition	Animations apply to objects within a slide: entrance, emphasis, exit and motion paths.
P4	**B**	.ppsx	.potx is a template and .pptm contains macros.
P5	**D**	Slide Sorter	It shows thumbnails that you can drag.
P6	**D**	Rehearse Timings	Slide Show → Rehearse Timings.
O1	**D**	BCC	Use BCC for large mailing lists to protect everyone's addresses.
O2	**D**	Ctrl + Shift + Esc	Ctrl + Alt + Del opens a menu that includes Task Manager.
O3	**A**	Win + L	Win + D shows the desktop.
O4	**A**	Plain-text values separated by commas (one sheet, no formatting)	CSV is universal but keeps only the data.
O5	**C**	Win + Shift + S	It opens the snipping toolbar. Win + P is for projector or display settings.

GET EXAM-READY

3-Day Plan & Cheat Sheet

Day	Plan (about 1.5 hours a day)
Day 1	Sections X1–X5. Type the sample sheet into Excel or Google Sheets and run **every** example formula. Practise copying formulas with $ references until you can predict the result instantly.
Day 2	Sections X6–X9: lookups, text, dates, errors and data tools. Build one pivot table and one chart, and add a drop-down with Data Validation. Do Practice Set 1 under time.
Day 3	Word, PowerPoint and the common apps. Learn the shortcut tables (the starred core items below). Do Practice Set 2, then revise every question you got wrong.

Excel in 12 lines

- $ locks what follows it · copying shifts, cutting doesn't · F4 toggles
- Precedence: – (negation) → % → ^ → * / → + – → & → comparisons · `=-3^2` = 9
- COUNT = numbers · COUNTA = non-empty · COUNTBLANK = empty
- SUMIF(range, criteria, **sum_range**) but SUMIFS(**sum_range**, range, criteria...)
- Criteria: `">50"`, `"<>HR"`, `"A*"`, `"?b"`, `">"&F1`
- VLOOKUP: first column, looks right, FALSE = exact · approximate needs sorted data
- INDEX + MATCH can look left · MATCH type 0 = exact
- INT rounds down · TRUNC chops · ROUND halves away from zero · MOD takes the divisor's sign
- FIND case-sensitive · SEARCH not case-sensitive + wildcards · SUBSTITUTE by text · REPLACE by position
- Errors: DIV/0 · N/A (not found) · VALUE (type) · REF (deleted) · NAME (typo) · NUM · NULL · #### (narrow)
- Validation = restrict input · Conditional formatting = change look · Freeze = keep headers · Goal Seek = find input
- 1,048,576 rows · 16,384 columns (XFD) · .xlsm = macros · .csv = one sheet of plain text

Word · PowerPoint · Apps in 12 lines

- Section break = different orientation, header or margins for part of a document
- Ctrl+Enter page break · Shift+Enter line break
- TOC is built from heading styles · footnote = same page · endnote = end of document
- Mail Merge (Mailings): main document + data source → personalised copies
- Track Changes (Review) → accept or reject · F7 spelling · Shift+F3 change case
- Watermark is on the Design tab · Format Painter copies formatting
- Slide Master = every slide · layouts = each type of slide
- Animation = objects (entrance, emphasis, exit, path) · Transition = between slides
- F5 from start · Shift+F5 from current · B black · W white · Esc end
- Slide Sorter = reorder · .ppsx opens as a show · Rehearse Timings
- BCC is hidden · Reply All doesn't include BCC · Ctrl+Shift+Esc opens Task Manager
- Win+L lock · Win+D desktop · Win+Shift+S snip · Win+V clipboard

Exam-day tip

For a formula-output question, **work out the answer yourself before looking at the options**. Wrong options are built from common mistakes, such as including the boundary value, using the wrong rounding direction or picking the wrong column. Then check that your answer is among the options.

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